

NVIDIA: Historical Events That Moved the Stock

1999 IPO → September 2026 | Concise year-by-year reference

Purpose

A compact historical timeline of the major technological, market, macroeconomic and geopolitical events that materially influenced NVIDIA (NVDA), with the approximate annual stock return shown as context. Returns are price/market-data reference figures and may differ slightly by data provider.

Year-by-Year Timeline

Year	Major event	Impact	Summary	Approx. NVDA annual return
1999	IPO / GPU era begins	■ Positive	NVIDIA went public and established itself as a major 3D-graphics company. The company's GPU strategy created the foundation for long-term gaming and computing growth.	~+138%
2000	Dot-com / tech boom	■ Positive	Technology stocks remained strong and demand for PC graphics hardware continued expanding. NVIDIA entered the new decade with strong momentum.	~+40%
2001	GeForce expansion	■ Positive	NVIDIA benefited from rapid growth in PC graphics and GeForce products. Despite the broader tech downturn, NVDA had an exceptional year.	~+308%
2002	Tech crash / semiconductor downturn	■ Negative	The technology bubble unwind and semiconductor weakness caused a severe valuation and demand reset. NVIDIA experienced one of its deepest historical declines.	~-83%
2003	Recovery + GeForce	■ Positive	Technology markets recovered and NVIDIA continued strengthening its position in PC graphics, producing a major rebound.	~+102%
2004	Consolidation	■ Mixed	A relatively quiet stock year as the company continued building its graphics franchise and preparing for the next phase of growth.	~+2%
2005	Gaming / GPU growth	■ Positive	Continued demand for increasingly powerful PC graphics supported NVIDIA's growth and investor optimism.	~+55%
2006	CUDA introduced	■■ Major Positive	NVIDIA introduced CUDA, allowing GPUs to be used for general-purpose parallel computing. This became a foundational technology for scientific computing and later AI.	~+103%
2007	GPU computing gains	■ Positive	NVIDIA continued benefiting from gaming and emerging GPU-computing applications, carrying strong momentum into the financial crisis.	~+38%
2008	Global Financial Crisis	■■ Major Negative	The global financial crisis hit technology and consumer demand hard. NVIDIA suffered one of its largest annual declines.	~-76%
2009	Post-crisis rebound	■ Positive	Markets recovered sharply after the financial crisis and NVIDIA rebounded alongside technology and semiconductor stocks.	~+132%
2010	Post-crisis normalization	■ Negative	The initial recovery faded into a more difficult period for the stock, despite continued product development.	~-18%
2011	Weak market / execution concerns	■ Negative	NVIDIA faced a softer stock environment as investors reassessed growth expectations and the broader technology market remained uneven.	~-10%
2012	AlexNet / modern AI begins	■■ Strategic Positive	NVIDIA GPUs powered the breakthrough AlexNet neural network. This was a turning point: GPUs moved from graphics hardware toward becoming the engine of modern deep learning.	~-11% stock year
2013	AI / GPU computing foundation	■ Positive	The importance of GPU acceleration continued increasing, creating the foundation for NVIDIA's future data-center and AI business.	~+34%

Year	Major event	Impact	Summary	Approx. NVDA annual return
2014	Kepler/Maxwell era	■ Positive	NVIDIA continued improving GPU performance and efficiency while expanding its gaming and professional-computing franchises.	~+27%
2015	Deep-learning adoption accelerates	■ Positive	Researchers and companies increasingly adopted GPU acceleration for machine learning, strengthening NVIDIA's strategic position.	~+67%
2016	Pascal + AI boom	■■ Major Positive	Pascal GPUs were highly successful while AI adoption accelerated. NVIDIA increasingly became associated with deep learning and accelerated computing.	~+227%
2017	AI + gaming + crypto demand	■■ Major Positive	Gaming, data-center AI and cryptocurrency mining all increased demand for NVIDIA GPUs. Investor expectations for long-term growth surged.	~+82%
2018	Crypto crash + inventory issues	■■ Major Negative	Cryptocurrency mining demand collapsed, leaving excess GPU inventory and weakening gaming revenue expectations. NVIDIA also faced scrutiny over disclosure of crypto-related demand.	~-31%
2019	Recovery	■ Positive	NVIDIA recovered from the crypto-related correction as gaming normalized and data-center/AI demand became increasingly important.	~+77%
2020	COVID + gaming + Mellanox	■■ Major Positive	The pandemic increased gaming and cloud-computing demand. NVIDIA also completed the Mellanox acquisition, strengthening networking and data-center infrastructure.	~+122%
2021	Data-center transformation	■■ Major Positive	AI, gaming, data centers and networking all expanded. NVIDIA increasingly looked like a full accelerated-computing platform rather than only a GPU vendor.	~+125%
2022	Crypto collapse + rates + gaming slowdown	■■ Major Negative	Crypto mining collapsed, gaming demand normalized, inventories rose and higher interest rates pressured high-growth technology valuations. NVIDIA fell roughly half for the year.	~-50%
2023	ChatGPT / generative AI explosion	■■■ Historic Positive	Generative AI created extraordinary demand for NVIDIA accelerators. H100/A100 systems became core infrastructure for AI training, and Wall Street sharply raised expectations.	~+239%
2024	Blackwell + AI infrastructure arms race	■■ Major Positive	NVIDIA launched Blackwell while hyperscalers and AI labs dramatically increased AI infrastructure spending. The 10-for-1 stock split improved share accessibility but did not itself create value.	~+171%
2025	DeepSeek shock + continued AI spending	■ then ■ Mixed	DeepSeek triggered a historic one-day selloff by raising questions about AI compute efficiency. The broader AI investment cycle nevertheless continued, supporting renewed growth.	~+39%
2026	Blackwell/Rubin + AI capex + China restrictions	■ / ■ Mixed	NVIDIA remained central to AI infrastructure, with Blackwell and next-generation Rubin supporting growth. At the same time, U.S.-China export restrictions and Chinese competition remained major structural risks.	~+24% YTD*

What the Timeline Tells Us

The 4 major eras

1999–2011: Gaming / graphics → 2012–2019: GPU computing + AI → 2020–2022: Data-center platform → 2023–2026: AI infrastructure platform.

Biggest strategic turning point

CUDA in 2006 created the software/programming ecosystem that allowed NVIDIA GPUs to become useful far beyond graphics.

AI turning point

The 2012 AlexNet breakthrough demonstrated that NVIDIA GPUs could dramatically accelerate deep learning, laying the groundwork for today's AI economy.

Biggest historical crashes

2002 (~-83%), 2008 (~-76%), 2022 (~-50%). These demonstrate that even NVIDIA's long-term growth story has experienced severe drawdowns.

Biggest modern catalyst

Generative AI beginning with ChatGPT in late 2022 and the resulting 2023 data-center demand shock fundamentally changed NVIDIA's valuation and revenue trajectory.

Key modern risk

Export restrictions to China can limit NVIDIA's addressable market and force product segmentation, while domestic Chinese AI-chip competition may increase over time.

Important context

The annual-return figures are included to show the market reaction around each period; they should not be interpreted as a causal measurement of the event itself. NVIDIA's stock can move for multiple reasons simultaneously, including earnings, valuation, macro conditions and investor expectations.

Sources

NVIDIA corporate history and annual-report archive; historical NVDA annual-return datasets. NVIDIA's official timeline identifies 1999 as the GPU milestone, 2006 as CUDA, and 2012 as the AlexNet/modern-AI milestone. Historical return figures are cross-checked against public market-data series.

Data note: 2026 return is year-to-date through the latest market data available in the research used for this document.